The Dhāraṇī of Noble Avalokiteśvara

Āryāvalokiteśvaranāmadhāraṇī · Toh 910 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་སྤྱན་ར་གཟིགས་དབང་ཕྱུག་གི་གཟུངས་ཞེས་བྱ།

The Dhāraṇī of Noble Avalokiteśvara, known in Sanskrit as Āryāvalokiteśvaranāmadhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Chenrezik Wangchuk gi Zung, is a short devotional and meditative work dedicated to Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva of great compassion. After an opening homage, it guides the practitioner through a visualization in which Avalokiteśvara, moved by loving-kindness and compassion, arises from the radiating and gathering of the seed syllable hrīḥ upon a seat of lotus, sun, and moon. He appears white in color with one face and four arms, his first two hands joined palm to palm, the others holding a rosary of white pearls and a white lotus, seated in full cross-legged posture, adorned with jewels and a jewel crown, and attended by the goddess Ṣaḍakṣarī and a male consort figure, a setting closely associated with the famous six-syllable mantra. The work is Toh 910 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the collections of incantations and accompanying practices preserved within the tantra section of the canon.

In the language of India: āryābalokiteśvara nāma dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī of Noble Avalokiteśvara.

Homage to noble Avalokiteśvara, endowed with great compassion.

Noble Avalokiteśvara, from a state of loving-kindness and through the force of compassion, fully generated the awakening mind. Then, upon a seat of lotus, sun, and moon, from the radiating and gathering of hrīḥ, he appeared with one face and four arms. The first two hands are joined palm to palm. The lower right holds a rosary of white pearls, and the lower left holds a white lotus. His body is white in color, and he sits with his legs in the full cross-legged posture. He is beautified by various jewel ornaments and a jewel crown. He is attended by the mother, the goddess Ṣaḍakṣarī, and by the father, Maṇiratna, and surrounded by a great many bodhisattvas and female bodhisattvas. He spoke these words:

"If a son of good family or a daughter of good family recites this mantra even just once, or remembers it and keeps it in mind, or writes it down and wears it on the body, or regards it with devotion and respect, then all of the five acts of immediate retribution, and all the evil deeds close to them, will be purified. Such a person will not be born in the three lower realms, nor in the eight

unfree states, nor into a life of suffering. They will be freed from all fears of humans, nonhumans, and wild beasts. They will be liberated from all diseases and grahas.

"By reciting oṃ maṇi padme hūṃ, one will see the face of noble Avalokiteśvara, and after passing from this life one will be born in Sukhāvatī. Have no doubt, hesitation, or wavering about this."

The Dhāraṇī of Noble Avalokiteśvara is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The Tibetan names the consort only as "the mother, the goddess Six." This is understood here as Ṣaḍakṣarī, the deity of the six-syllable mantra. The father is called "Precious Jewel," which is rendered as Maṇiratna. This Sanskrit form is a reconstruction, and the figure may correspond to the companion usually known as Maṇidhara.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.